What Is Contemporary Art? ✕

Today's goal • 0/3 items
Complete 3 items today to stay at a good pace!

Module 1
Introduction to What Is Contemporary Art?

Module 2
Media from Television to the Internet

Module 3
Territories & Transit

Module 4
Materials & Making

Module 5
Agency

Visibility

- ✓ Introduction to Module 5
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Pope.L's New York crawls
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ In New York City with Pope.L | Direct action
  Video • 4 min
- ✓ Two artists consider Catherine Opie, Dyke, 1993
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Tania Bruguera on Untitled (Havana, 2000), 2000
  Video • 4 min
- ✓ Luis Camnitzer on Memorial, 2009
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Yara Said on the Refugee Flag, 2016
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Firelei Báez on For Améthyste and Athénaïre (Exiled Muses Beyond Jean Luc Nancy's Canon), Anacaonas, 2018
  Reading • 10 min

Voice

- ✓ Who speaks?
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Nick Cave on Soundsuit, 2011
  Video • 2 min
- ○ **Lawrence Abu Hamdan, Conflicted Phonemes, 2012**
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ P Staff on Weed Killer, 2017
  Reading • 10 min

Action

- ○ Taking action
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Lorraine O'Grady on Mlle Bourgeoise Noire, 1980–83/2009
  Video • 2 min
- ○ Xiao Lu on Dialogue, 1989
  Video • 2 min
- ○ Ralph Borland, Suited for Subversion (Prototype), 2002
  Video • 1 min
- ○ Defining and blurring identities through performance
  Reading • 10 min

Review & Respond

- ○ Memory Check
  Practice Assignment
- ○ Reflect on Agency in Module 5
  Dialogue • 15 min
- ○ Optional Readings & Resources
  Reading • 10 min

Module 6
Power

Exposing Power

- ○ Introduction to Module 6
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Instructor Christian Rattemeyer on Mark Lombardi's diagrams of power
  Video • 6 min
- ○ What do war and peace have to do with chandeliers and portraits?
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Deana Lawson on Nation, 2017
  Video • 2 min

Abuse of Power

- ○ How do artists critique power?
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Two responses to abuse of power
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Wolfgang Tillmans on Sendeschluss / End of Broadcast I, 2014
  Video • 2 min

Sources of Power

- ○ Power: sources and resources
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Outer space to inner earth
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Curator Paola Antonelli on Massoud Hassani's Mine Kafon wind-powered deminer, 2011
  Video • 1 min
- ○ Rania Ghosn on After Oil, 2016
  Video • 4 min

Review & Respond

- ○ Memory Check
  Practice Assignment
- ○ Reflecting on Power in Art
  Dialogue • 15 min
- ○ Final course reflection
  Graded Assignment • 30 min
- ○ Optional Readings & Resources
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ End-of-course survey
  Reading • 5 min
- ○ Recordings of live virtual sessions (optional)
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ MoMA Resources
  Reading • 10 min

Lawrence Abu Hamdan, Conflicted Phonemes, 2012

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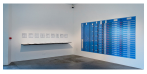
Lawrence Abu Hamdan, *Conflicted Phonemes*, 2012



Lawrence Abu Hamdan. *Conflicted Phonemes*. 2012. Vinyl wall print, nine A4 sized vinyl prints, and nine stacks of printed A4 paper, sheet: 105 × 81" (266.7 × 205.7 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Fund for the Twenty-First Century. © 2019 Lawrence Abu Hamdan

Lawrence Abu Hamdan calls himself a "private ear." He considers himself an investigator, with a focus on sound, especially the sounds of language and the voice. From this angle, he illuminates aspects of geopolitics and government policies that may be understood differently or more completely through careful listening.

With *Conflicted Phonemes*, Abu Hamdan critiques the use of language analysis on asylum seekers by immigration authorities, in this case 12 Somalis whose requests were rejected by Dutch authorities. The method involves recording an interview with the asylum seeker and then analyzing their accent to determine if it matches that of the place from which they claim to have come. But, as Abu Hamdan argues, "[The voice is] not like a birth certificate or a passport; it's more like a network, it's somehow a register of everyone you have ever spoken to in your life." Working collaboratively with the 12 Somalis and others, he created an installation of maps detailing the numerous networks comprising each individual voice.

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